

Microsoft 365 Copilot

Analytics — Executive Briefing

What analytics are available, what decisions to make, and how to measure ROI

Document Property	Value
Section	Strategy
Audience	CIO, Solution Architect, Business Leaders
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How This Document Fits

This is a **Strategy** guide. Read this before deployment to understand what Copilot analytics capabilities exist and what decisions your organisation needs to make. Once decisions are made, hand off to your IT team with the Admin Setup Guide.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy (you are here)	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

1. What Copilot Analytics Can Tell You

Microsoft describes **six Copilot Analytics areas**. They are complementary reporting surfaces rather than a mandatory maturity sequence.

Official capability area	Primary question
Microsoft 365 admin center reports	Who is licensed and using Copilot or Copilot Chat?
Microsoft Copilot Dashboard	How are adoption, impact, and sentiment changing?
Agent Dashboard (preview)	Which agents are being adopted and how are they used?
Consumption Dashboard	Where are Copilot Credits being consumed?
Copilot Analytics reports	What do ready-to-use adoption and impact reports show?
Advanced Reporting	What custom cohorts, comparisons, and business outcomes need deeper analysis?

Source: Copilot Analytics introduction (Last updated 9 February 2026) and How to use the Consumption Dashboard in Insights (Last updated 20 July 2026).

This guide’s implementation framework

The five-stage sequence below is this guide’s implementation framework, not a Microsoft product classification. It groups the six official areas into a practical rollout order; the Consumption Dashboard is treated as a cost-management companion across stages rather than as a separate stage.

Tier 1

M365 Admin Center Reports
IT Admins
License & usage tracking
No setup needed



Tier 2

Copilot Dashboard
Leaders & Managers
ROI, Adoption, Sentiment
1+ licenses



Tier 3

Copilot Analytics Reports

Leaders & Analysts
Out-of-the-box reports
Dashboard access



Tier 4

Agent Dashboard

Leaders & Analysts
Agent adoption & usage
Preview; conservative gate: 50+ Copilot licenses plus agent activity



Tier 5

Advanced Analytics (Power BI)

Analysts
Custom queries & reports
Viva Insights license

Suggested rollout order only. Validate licensing, cloud support, tenant rollout, and access separately for each capability.

Which Dashboard Answers Which Question?

Dashboard	Best For	Setup Time	Key Capabilities
Admin Center Reports	IT Admins tracking license usage	None (built-in)	User-level insights
Copilot Dashboard	Business leaders measuring ROI	Up to 7 days	Copilot usage trends
Copilot Analytics Reports	Leaders wanting targeted insights	Same as Dashboard	Out-of-the-box analytics
Agent Dashboard (preview)	Leaders tracking agent adoption	Tenant validation required	Agent usage metrics
Consumption Dashboard	FinOps and leaders monitoring Copilot Credits	Role and scope dependent	Credit usage and trends
Advanced Analytics (Power BI)	Analysts doing deep-dive analysis	1–2 weeks	Before/after analysis

Level-of-Effort Summary

Tier	Active Config	Wait/Processing	Ongoing Maintenance	Personas Needed
Admin Center	15–30 min	72 hours	None	Global Admin or
Copilot Dashboard	2–4 hours	Up to 7 days	Monthly org data refresh	GA, AI Admin, In
Copilot Analytics Reports	None (auto)	Same as Dashboard	None	Dashboard acce
Agent Dashboard	10 min (verify)	Same as Dashboard	None	AI Admin, comp
Advanced Analytics	4–8 hours	Query-dependent	Monthly refresh + query re-runs	Insights Admin,

Implementation Timeline

- **Day 1:** Admin Center reports available (~72 hours after first Copilot usage)
- **Day 7:** Copilot Dashboard + Copilot Analytics Reports fully populated (if prerequisites met)
- **Day 7 or later:** Agent Dashboard may appear after preview prerequisites, agent activity, access, cloud support, and tenant rollout are satisfied
- **Week 2+:** Advanced Analytics operational (after org data upload and query setup)

2. Decisions You Need to Make

2.1 Pre-Configuration Discovery Questions

Before your IT team touches any configuration, you should be able to answer these:

#	Question
1	How many qualifying Viva Insights service plans are assigned (not merely purchased), and how many are Microsoft
2	Is the Entra ID manager hierarchy populated for most users?
3	Do you have an HR data export available (department, function, location)?
4	Has anyone been assigned the AI Administrator role?
5	Do you have compliance/legal requirements to exclude specific users?
6	Has Copilot already been rolled out, or is it pre-deployment?
7	Do you use Viva Glint or Viva Pulse for employee surveys?
8	What is the primary reporting need: Copilot-only or broader productivity?
9	Are you deploying Copilot agents / Copilot Studio agents?
10	Who are the target report consumers (IT admins, BU leaders, analysts)?

2.2 Decision Framework

1. Do you need user-level license utilization data? → Start with **Admin Center Reports**
2. Do you have 1+ assigned Copilot licences AND want ROI metrics? → Enable **Copilot Dashboard** (50+ for advanced features)
3. Do leaders want ready-to-use targeted reports? → **Copilot Analytics Reports** (auto-available with Dashboard)
4. Are you deploying agents (Copilot Studio, etc.)? → Validate and enable the **Agent Dashboard (preview)**
5. Do you need to monitor Copilot Credits by service or organisational scope? → Use the **Consumption Dashboard**, then reconcile with official billing records
6. Do you need before/after adoption analysis or custom segmentation? → Configure **Advanced Analytics**

TIP: Progressive Implementation

Most customers benefit from implementing this guide's framework progressively. Start with admin center reports, add the Copilot Dashboard and Analytics Reports, validate the Agent and Consumption dashboards where relevant, then add Advanced Reporting for custom analysis.

3. Capability Comparison

Capability	Admin Center	Copilot Dashboard
Primary Audience	IT Admins	Leaders, Managers
Minimum Licenses	Report-specific	1+ Copilot for core; advanced access uses a disputed 50-plan threshold that
Setup Complexity	None	Low–Medium
Data Latency	~72 hours	Up to 6 days
User-Level Tracking	Yes	No (group-level)
ROI Metrics	No	Assisted Hours/Value
Sentiment Data	No	Yes
Agent Tracking	No	Preview
Before/After Analysis	No	No
Export Capabilities	CSV	Preview CSV: anonymized user-level rows; 6 months weekly or 28 days daily; t

Licensing and preview sources: Environment requirements for Viva Insights (Last updated 12 May 2026), Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 18 August 2026), and Connect to the Agent Dashboard (Last updated 30 July 2026). These Microsoft pages conflict on the mixed threshold and Agent Dashboard prerequisite; validate in the tenant and escalate through Microsoft Support if documented service-plan eligibility does not unlock the capability after processing.

4. Who Does What (RACI)

Activity	Global Admin	AI Admin	Insights Admin	Insight
Assign Copilot/Viva licences	R/A	—	—	
Assign Insights Admin/Analyst roles	R/A	—	—	
Enable/disable Viva feature access management (VFAM) policies	—	R/A	—	
Configure Manager Settings	—	C	R/A	
Upload organizational data	C	—	R/A	
Configure privacy / group size	—	C	R/A	
Create exclusion lists	—	R/A	—	
Run Advanced Analytics queries	—	—	C	R
Delegate dashboard access	—	—	—	
View & act on insights	I	—	—	

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed

5. Key Concepts for Leaders

5.1 Copilot Assisted Hours & Value

The primary ROI metric. Composed of three categories:

Category	What's counted	Assistance factor
Meeting Summaries	Duration of each meeting summarized by Copilot	Actual meeting duration (variable)
Search & Summaries	Chat prompts, email/doc summaries, analysis	6 minutes per action
Content Creation	Draft email, Draft in Word, Create presentation	6 minutes per action

Assisted Value = Assisted Hours × Hourly Rate (default \$72/hour, configurable per session).

Diagnostic coverage and causality

Optional diagnostic data affects Copilot assisted hours, emails sent using Copilot, Teams meetings and meeting hours summarized or recapped, and Teams chats summarized. Required diagnostic data still supplies a subset, so disabled optional diagnostics can undercount these measures. Confirm the tenant’s diagnostic-data policy and metric coverage before comparing groups or periods.

Assisted Hours and Assisted Value are modeled estimates based on Microsoft’s assumptions and a session-only hourly rate. They do not prove realized savings or that Copilot caused a business outcome. Use a documented baseline, stable diagnostic coverage, and business outcome data before making ROI or causal claims.

Source: Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 18 August 2026), Impact section.

5.2 Licensing — What You Get with Copilot

Every M365 Copilot licence **automatically includes** the Viva Insights service plan at no additional cost. That bundled plan contributes to Viva Insights eligibility, but each capability still has its own assigned-plan threshold, role, access, data, cloud, and preview requirements. A separate Viva Insights purchase is needed when the measured population includes employees who do not receive the bundled plan through Copilot.

5.3 Privacy by Design

- **No individual tracking:** All dashboard data is aggregated at group level

- **Minimum group size:** Default 10 (configurable down to 5)
- **Differential privacy:** Automatically applied to protect individuals
- **Exclusion lists:** Remove specific users from all analytics

5.4 Known Metric Underreporting

Microsoft has acknowledged two data collection issues. No action needed — data auto-corrects after the affected windows.

Affected Metrics	Affected Period
Email features (drafts, summaries)	June 1, 2025 – February 18, 2026
Meeting features (summaries, recap)	September 6 – November 3, 2025

6. Scope & Limitations

In Scope

- Microsoft 365 Copilot applications: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, Loop, OneNote, Edge, Copilot Chat
- Six official capability areas: admin center reports, Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard, Copilot Analytics reports, and Advanced Reporting
- License utilization, ROI measurement, sentiment analysis, agent adoption

Out of Scope

- Other Copilot products: Copilot for Sales, Copilot for Service, GitHub Copilot, Security Copilot
- **Copilot Chat users without a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence:** covered by the current Microsoft 365 admin center **Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat usage report** and, when enabled and available, the Copilot Dashboard's Copilot Chat view. Microsoft Graph's licensed Copilot usage endpoint remains licensed-user only; use the admin report or appropriate Purview audit source for unlicensed scenarios.
- Broader Viva Insights productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time) — see Collaboration Analysis Guide

Current Copilot Chat reporting

The Microsoft 365 admin center provides a dedicated usage report for Copilot Chat users without a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, including exportable user activity. The Copilot Dashboard also provides a Copilot Chat licence view when reporting is enabled and available. These are different from licensed-user Microsoft Graph usage reporting and from Purview audit evidence.

Source: Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat usage report (Last updated 10 July 2026) and Microsoft 365 Copilot reporting options for admins (Last updated 16 September 2025).

7. What to Read Next

If you need to...	Read this
Decide your HR data / org data approach	Data Strategy (Strategy layer)
Understand multi-agency architecture options	Multi-Agency Decision Guide (Strategy layer)
Hand off to IT for implementation	Admin Setup Guide (Setup layer)
Understand how to connect HR data	Data Onboarding Guide (Setup layer)
Learn to read the dashboards	Dashboard & Reports Guide (Operate layer)
Understand billing and licence lifecycle	Billing Operations (Operate layer)

Disclaimer

This guide is provided as a procedural reference and may not reflect the latest product changes. Always refer to the official Viva Insights and Microsoft 365 Copilot documentation on Microsoft Learn for the most up-to-date information.